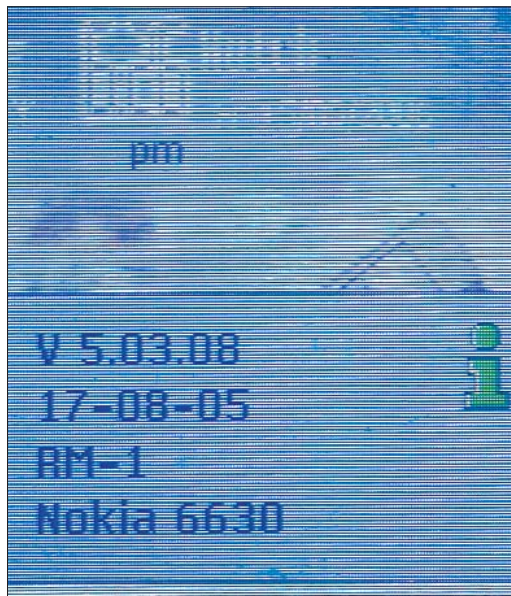


SYMBIAN TRICKS

The Symbian OS in its Series 60 (now known as S60) avatar is by far the most popular, powering a majority of smartphones around the world. Whether you have a Nokia 6600 or an N70 or a Samsung X700, these tricks should provide a richer experience with that phone, besides demonstrating the power of the S60 platform.

Check Your Firmware Version Number

You can check your phone's model number, the OS version and its date of release on your Symbian Series 60 phone by pressing the key combination ***#0000#**. This is particularly useful in case you plan a firmware upgrade and want to know what version you are currently using.



Checking your firmware version number

The End Call key

The red button on your Symbian cell phone that is used to end an active call can also be used to quick return to the main menu. Say you are using notepad, and need to type a quick SMS. Use the end key to be taken to the startup (home) screen. The notepad application is simply minimized to memory and not closed. Later on, when you wish to get back to the notepad where you were working all you need to do is access the task manager and switch to the notepad task. This works for all applications, and you can switch between several applications in this way.

Selecting multiple files

This tip is for all those who have a huge inbox of say 300-plus SMSes, and



Selecting multiple files

want to delete many at a time. Keep the edit button pressed (the one with the pencil), simply scroll through your messages, and you'll find that they get a check/tick mark besides them. To keep a message you want, simply let go of the edit button while scrolling past it. Pressing the delete ([C]) key will delete all the messages that have been check marked. This trick works for all files.

Deep Format

Sometimes your S60 phone may boot up to the Nokia screen and nothing else. This little tip is also useful when you are unable to delete some files from your C: drive (you will need a utility like FE Explorer installed to view drive partitions) available for download at http://www.gosymbian.com/FE_download.html. There is a

hard format option which works on the newer crop of S60 phones. Before following the following steps please ensure that you have at least 75 percent of battery charge left, if this format process is interrupted you'll be compelled to make a trip to your nearest Nokia center for a complete software install.

Shutdown your S60 phone, and remove the memory card. Now press the green (call) key, your [*] (asterisk) key and the number [3]. Keep them pressed while you power on your phone. Do not release any of these three keys until you see a formatting screen appear. After the format is complete your cell phone will be back to its factory default state.

Smart memory card removal

When removing your memory card, always power down the phone and remove it. Though some S60 phones sport hot swap, you will find the themes and icon arrangement switches to default after you put the memory card back. This happens with all S60 phones simply because most themes would be stored on your card by default. When you power off the phone and remove the card, your OS cannot determine that it's been removed. So power down and swap away, your current theme and icon settings will survive the MC swap.

Startup in Safe Mode

Starting up in safe mode is very useful for basic debugging—diagnosing whether a memory card is corrupt, or if you are getting a system error. Safe mode does is prevents third-party applications on your phone from auto starting, making troubleshooting easier. To boot into safe mode simply power down your S60 phone and power up again with the edit (pencil) key pressed. Now you'll be asked for your lock code if you have one. If not, you'll boot into safe mode, and can double check this by keeping the menu button pressed and checking the running programs.

Auto Saving SMSes

This tip is for you if you have an older S60 phone say an N-Gage, or an X700. You cannot save SMSes to your MMC (this feature is factory disabled because these phones don't support hot swapping, though it can be done on 6630s and later phones).

Backup your messages before this, because even though they're on your phone, this trick doesn't move current messages from your C: drive (we're assuming you have FE explorer installed), it just changes the default path for future messages, you won't be able to see them, unless you change the path again. In case you are doing this to save space, after backing all the SMSes up, delete them from your C: drive.

You'll need to install MsvDriveE (available at <http://www.carareok.com/bluemint/index.php/p98>).

Run this application just once, change your message storage to E: (MMC) from C: (phone mem). You can create folders as required. To switch back to the default phone memory follow these steps in order—simply switch off your phone, remove the MMC card, switch the phone back on, navigate to messaging and you're done. Oh, you can re-insert your MMC card now! ■